

MimiWork • by QualiTaTi

The coworker that hands you the finished file.

The complete guide – install it, sign in, hand it your folder, and go from "can you analyse my interviews?" to **summary.docx** in one ask. Basics first, then the habits of power users.



PART I

The basics

Fifteen minutes: install, create your account, meet the tour, and get your first finished document back. Every screenshot is the real app.





STEP 1

Install it

Mac (Apple Silicon or Intel) – download the DMG from github.com/lanceyuu/mimiwork/releases/latest, drag MimiWork to Applications, then **right-click** → **Open** once (the build is not yet code-signed, so macOS asks the first time).

Windows 10/11 – run **MimiWork-windows-setup.exe**; when SmartScreen appears, click **More info** → **Run anyway**. The app updates itself from then on.

YOUR MACHINE	FILE TO DOWNLOAD
Mac – Apple Silicon (M1-M4)	MimiWork-macos-arm64.dmg
Mac – Intel	MimiWork-macos-x64.dmg
Windows 10/11	MimiWork-windows-setup.exe (or .msi)

Privacy, before anything else. MimiWork is fully local: the agent, your conversations, and your keys live on your machine. There is no vendor cloud in the loop, and nothing outside the folders you grant is readable.

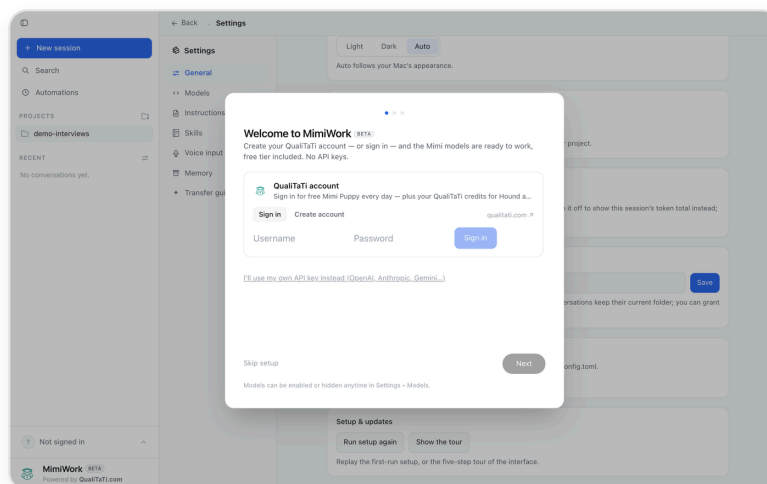


STEP 2

Create your QualiTaTi account

The first thing MimiWork asks is not which model to pick – it's who you are. **Create a QualiTaTi account right in the app** (or sign in with the one you have) and the Mimi models are ready to work, free tier included, nothing to configure:

- **Mimi Puppy** – free every day, and the app's default model from the moment you sign in.
- **Mimi Hound** – fast, for everyday documents and analysis.
- **Mimi Wolf** – the most capable, for the work that matters.



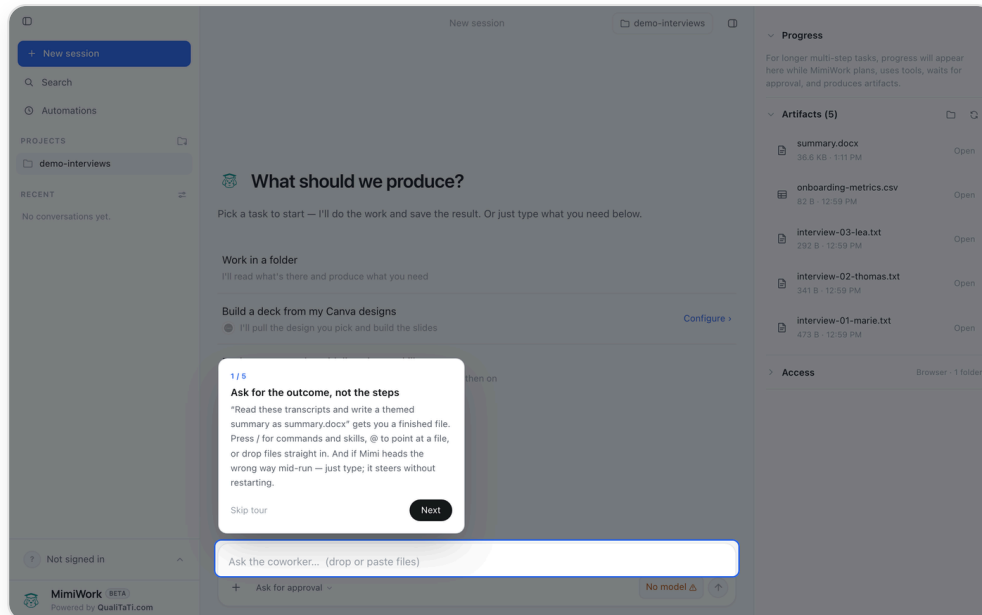
First run: sign in or create your account without leaving the app. Prefer your own API key? One link below.



STEP 3

Let the app show you around

After setup, MimiWork gives you a five-step tour of itself – spotlights over the real interface, not a slideshow: where to ask, the three permission gears, your folder, the progress panel, and where everything else lives. Replay it anytime from **Settings** → **General** → **Show the tour**.



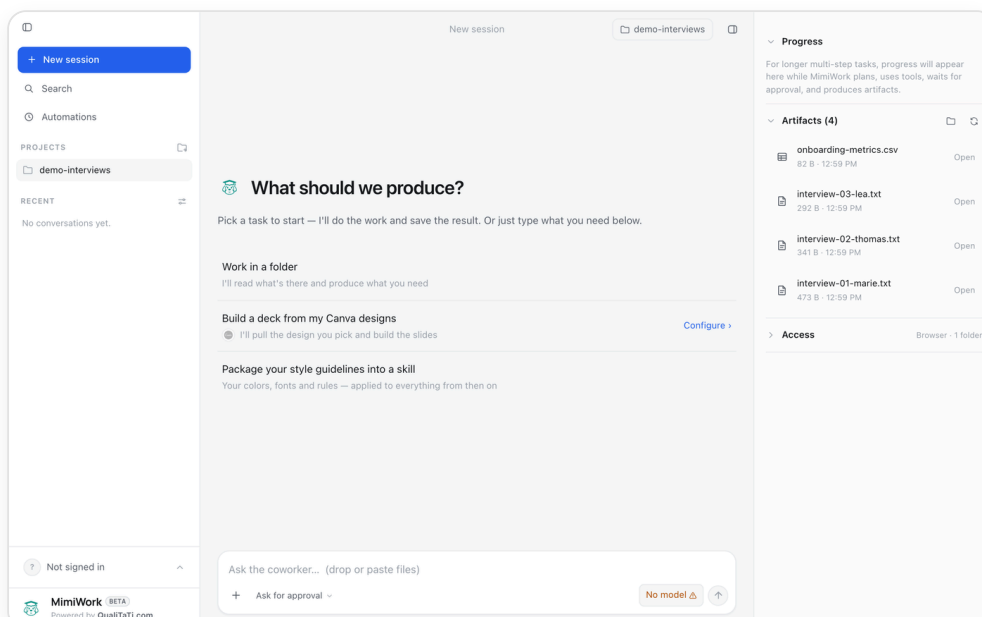
The tour points at the live interface, one spotlight at a time – Esc skips, arrows navigate.



STEP 4

Give it a folder

Click the folder starter card, or simply ask "work in my interviews folder". The folder you grant is the workspace: files are read there, and finished deliverables are saved there – visible in Finder or Explorer, not hidden inside the app.



MimiWork – the basics



STEP 5

Your first real task

The one habit that separates good results from chat: **ask for the outcome, not the steps.**

Read the three interview transcripts in this folder and write a one-page themed summary as `summary.docx` – quote each participant once, and end with the three changes we should make.

The screenshot shows the Mimi Puppy interface with a task card at the top: "Read the three interview transcripts in this folder and write a one-page themed summary as `summary.docx` – quote each participant once, and end with the three changes we should make." Below the task card, the chat history shows the assistant's initial response: "Running 4 steps... I'll read the three transcripts first, then draft the themed summary." and "Thinking...". On the right, the "Progress" section shows a checklist with three items: "Read the three interview transcripts" (checked), "Identify themes and pick one quote per participant" (unchecked), and "Write one-page summary.docx ending with three changes" (unchecked). Below the checklist, it says "4 tool calls so far." and "Artifacts (4)" with a list of files: "onboarding-metrics.csv", "interview-03-lea.txt", "interview-02-thomas.txt", and "interview-01-marie.txt". At the bottom, there is a status bar showing "Mimi is working — type to steer it mid-run...", a cost of "15.4k", and a "Stop" button.

Mimi at work on the free tier: the plan appears as a live checklist in Progress.

The screenshot shows the Mimi Puppy interface with the task card at the top. Below the task card, the chat history shows the assistant's response: "7 steps" and "ASSISTANT" followed by "Thought process" and "summary.docx is ready — one page, three themes, one quote per participant, ending with the action list." The assistant then provides a detailed summary of the interviews, including a list of three recommended changes: "1. The first week shows features, not the job to be done — Marie (quote: 'I don't want a tour, I want a nudge.').", "2. One flow for every user type — Thomas nearly churned as a freelancer stuck in team-invite loops", and "3. Value arrives late, by accident, on the wrong device — Thomas found report templates in week two by luck; Léa's quote ('If you judged the product by the phone alone I'd have quit.').". Below the summary, it says "The three recommended changes, in order: a single 'next step' nudge tied to the first real job (exporting a report), a solo-vs-team branch asked once during setup, and surfacing report templates in week one plus fixing the mobile core loop." On the right, the "Progress" section shows a checklist with three items: "Read the three interview transcripts" (checked), "Identify themes and pick one quote per participant" (checked), and "Write one-page summary.docx ending with three changes" (checked). Below the checklist, it says "Artifacts (1)" with a list of files: "summary.docx". At the bottom, there is a status bar showing "Ask the coworker... (drop or paste files)", a cost of "66.4k", and a "Stop" button.

Done: `summary.docx` in Artifacts, one click from opening in Word – this run cost nothing (Mimi Puppy · free for use).



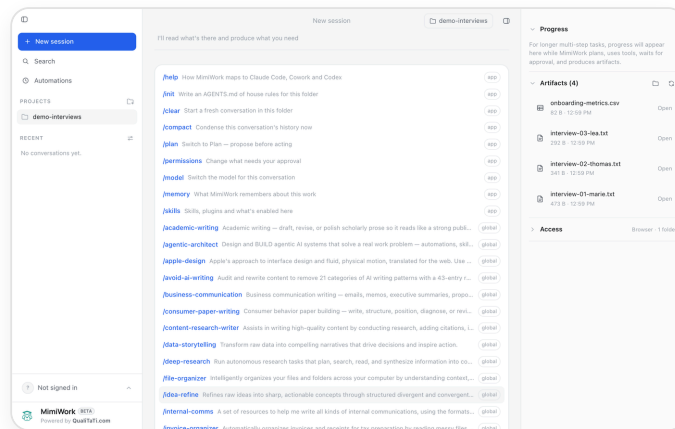
STEP 6

Three keys to learn

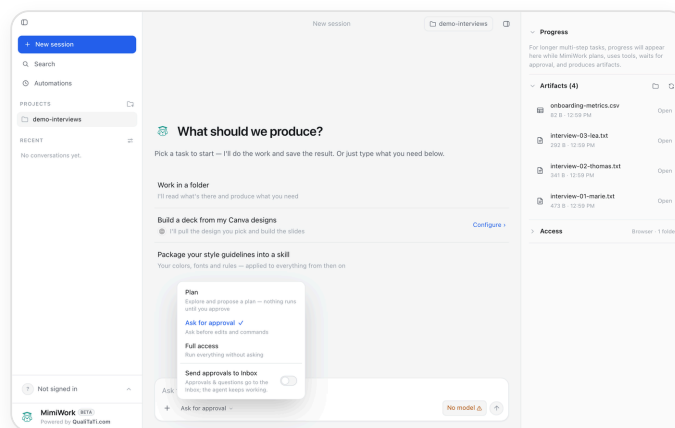
KEY WHAT IT DOES

- /** The command palette: app commands (/plan, /compact, /init, /model...), your saved commands, and your skills – same names as Claude Code and Cowork, so the habit transfers both ways.
- @** Point at a specific file in a granted folder. No path typing – start typing the name and pick.
- ⇧Tab** Cycle the permission mode: **Plan** → **Ask for approval** → **Full access**.

Plan mode is the professional gear. For anything with stakes, hit **⇧Tab** into Plan first: Mimi proposes the whole approach, you approve or redirect, and only then does it run. One minute reading a plan beats twenty redoing the work.



Press / – app commands, saved commands and skills in one palette.



Shift-Tab cycles the three permission modes; each row names its equivalent in Cowork and Claude Code.

PART II

Power use

Steering mid-run, teaching it your standards, connecting your tools, and making it work while you sleep – the habits that turn a tool into a colleague.



**ADV. 1**

Steer it while it works

You never have to watch Mimi go the wrong way. **Just type.** Your message lands at the next safe step of the running work – nothing stops, nothing restarts, and the instruction is never lost:

Use the December wave, not November – and report effect sizes, not just p-values.

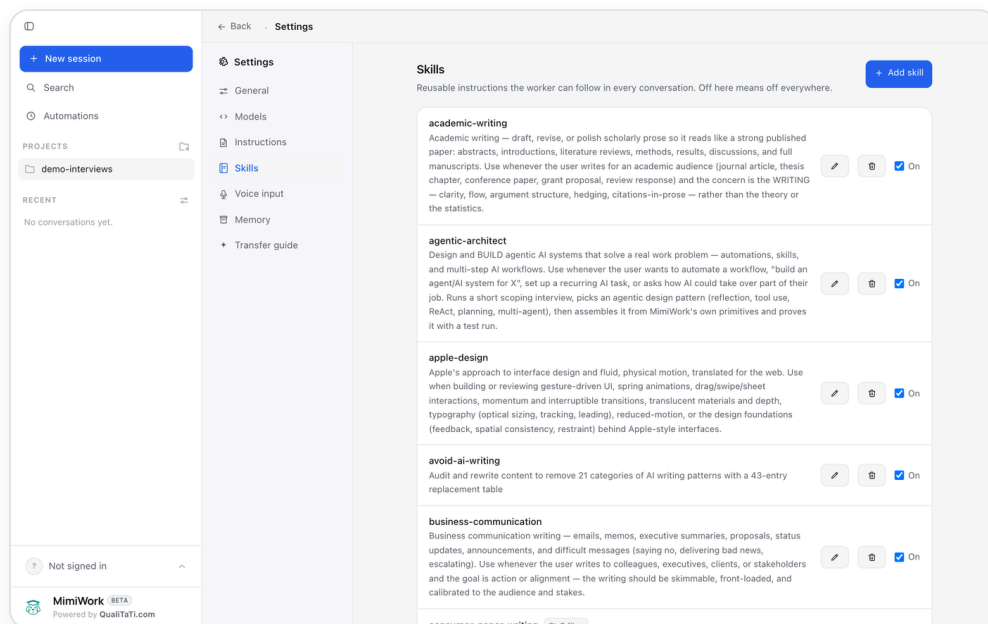
Two guardrails run underneath: a **repetition guard** notices a model going in circles and stops it before it burns your credits, and web searches that repeat answer from cache instead of re-billing.

**ADV. 2**

Teach it your way – once

The difference between a tool and a colleague is that a colleague remembers.

- **Instructions** (Settings → Instructions, or an **AGENTS.md** in the folder – CLAUDE.md is read too): standing rules. *"Reports in UK English. Never touch /raw."*
- **Skills** (Settings → Skills): packaged know-how – brand colors, fonts, house rules, methods. Package once; every deck and document comes out in them without being asked. Browse 8,400 community skills, and read a skill's real instructions before it ever lands on disk. Skills you already have in ~/.claude/skills import in one click.
- **Memory** (Settings → Memory): what Mimi noticed and kept – review, edit, delete.

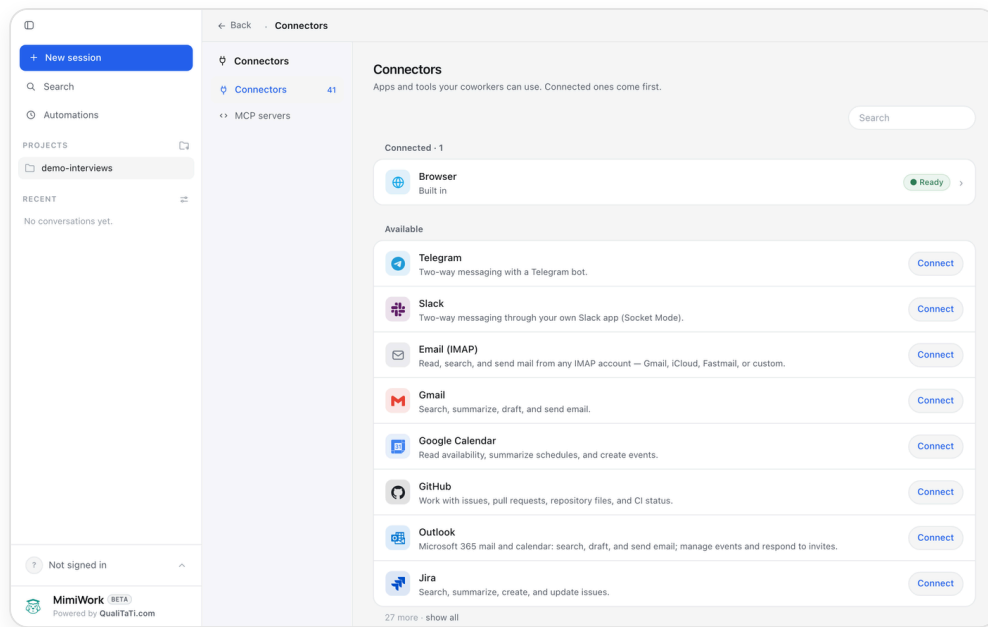


The Skills tab: your skills, the community store, and import from Claude Code.



ADV. 3

Connect where you work



The connector catalog – each one states exactly what access it gets before you connect it.

Slack (tag Mimi in a channel; finished work returns as a thread reply), Gmail and Outlook, Google Calendar and Drive, GitHub, Jira, Notion, Canva, monday.com – plus anything that speaks MCP. Two connectors matter especially for research:

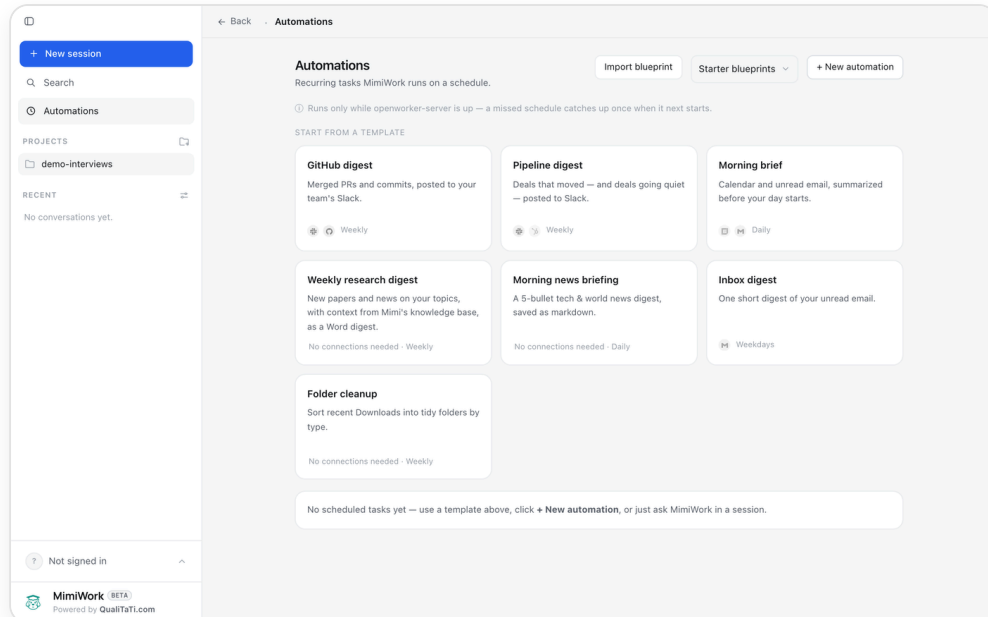
- **Qualtrics** – Mimi reads the questionnaire first, so *Q4_1* arrives as the question it actually asks; then pulls responses as CSV or a labelled SPSS .sav, ready for analysis. Each download asks your approval; nothing in Qualtrics is ever edited or sent.
- **QualiTaTi research data** – signed in, your projects, interview transcripts and survey responses are one ask away, each retrieval approval-gated.



ADV. 4

Make it run while you don't

Every Monday at 8, read the new files in field-notes/ and put a one-page weekly summary in reports/.



Automations run locally on schedule, with full transcripts; decisions wait in your Inbox.



ADV. 5

Know what it costs – exactly



The Activity page: every model call, its credit cost, and which pool paid – straight from the server's ledger, never an estimate.

Every call Mimi makes appears here with its real cost and which pool paid – team points, monthly points, or purchased credits. And a switch in **Settings** → **Models** picks where the models run: *Default* · *US* (cheaper credits) or *Strict GDPR* · *Paris* (data stays in Europe) – it applies to your next message, on every device.



ADV. 6

A good week, in five asks

1. "Work in this folder. Profile every .sav in it and give me a data dictionary as a Word doc."
2. "Package our brand guidelines into a skill." – every future deck is on-brand.
3. "Turn the wave-2 findings into a 12-slide deck for the steering committee." (in Plan mode)
4. "Pull the December survey from Qualtrics as SPSS and test whether satisfaction differs by channel – effect sizes, not just p-values."
5. "Every Friday at 4, summarise this Slack channel's week into a memo in reports/."

By Friday: a data dictionary, an on-brand deck, a real analysis, and a standing automation – every file on your disk, under your approval.

If something looks wrong – macOS "unidentified developer": right-click → Open, once.
 Windows SmartScreen: More info → Run anyway. A model that stops answering: Settings → Models → Test names the exact problem. Lost? Settings → General → Show the tour.



**Mimi rests.
Your automations don't.**

MimiWork – free and open source, by the QualiTaTi team.
github.com/lanceyuu/mimiwork · qualitati.com